

Northwind Cloud - Incident Response Runbook (v3.2, effective January 2026)

1. Purpose

This runbook defines how Northwind Cloud detects, classifies, escalates and resolves production incidents. It applies to every engineer on the on-call rotation and to the Incident Commander role.

2. Severity levels

SEV1: complete outage of a customer-facing service, data loss, or a confirmed security breach. Acknowledge within 5 minutes and mitigate within 1 hour. SEV2: major degradation affecting more than 10% of customers or a single enterprise customer. Acknowledge within 15 minutes and mitigate within 4 hours. SEV3: minor degradation with a workaround available. Acknowledge within 1 business hour. SEV4: cosmetic issues and internal tooling problems, handled through the normal backlog.

3. Escalation

For a SEV1 incident the primary on-call engineer must page the secondary on-call engineer, the Incident Commander on duty and the VP of Engineering through PagerDuty. If the primary on-call engineer does not acknowledge within 5 minutes, PagerDuty automatically escalates to the secondary. For a SEV2 incident, page the secondary on-call and the Incident Commander.

4. Communication

The Incident Commander opens a dedicated Slack channel named #inc-YYYYMMDD-short-name. For SEV1 and SEV2 incidents the status page must be updated within 15 minutes of declaration and then at least every 30 minutes until resolution. Customer Support is notified in #support-escalations.

5. Closing an incident

An incident is closed only after metrics have been stable for 30 minutes. A blameless postmortem is mandatory for every SEV1 and SEV2 incident and must be published within 5 business days.